

Austin Dase

Director of Engineering, Fundrise
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Selected work

PRODUCT · 0→1

RealAI

Fundrise's flagship AI product, taken from early prototype through public launch and still under active development; built on Next.js, TypeScript, and Vercel. An agent harness with MCP servers, prompt and context architecture, and a suite of tools for LLMs to produce high-quality real estate analysis.

PRODUCT · 0→1

Equitize

Fundrise's private secondary-market securities platform, shipped from concept to launch and scaled to millions in transaction volume. Concept, prototype, architecture, and implementation — then operating the platform.

INFRASTRUCTURE

Payments, KYC, and settlement at Fundrise

The systems underneath the platform: an ACH processing architecture handling \$1B+ in annual transaction volume, a Stripe debit funding integration that processed 40k+ transactions in its first year, automated KYC for every user, and automated transfer-agent reconciliation replacing a manual process.

OPEN SOURCE

Spring AI – Anthropic integration

Two contributions merged into Spring AI's Anthropic support: `tool_choice` controls for Claude function calling, and per-message TTL plus configurable cache-block usage for prompt caching, shipped in 1.1.0-M2.

Experience

Fundrise

Nov 2019 – Present

Jan 2026 – Present

Director of Engineering

Engineering direction for AI-enabled products at Fundrise, including RealAI — hands-on through design, implementation, and review.

- Leading RealAI's latest set of features and capabilities ahead of an expanded public release.
 - Own the technical direction for our AI-enabled products: model selection, prompt and context architecture, tool use, and overall harness design.
 - Work directly with product and company leadership to take concepts from prototype to production systems.
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Jan 2022 – Dec 2025

Lead Software Engineer & Engineering Manager

Led the engineering shipping new products, including RealAI, Fundrise's flagship AI product.

- Architected and shipped RealAI from conception to launch, establishing the technical roadmap and our LLM engineering practices.
- Built AI-enabled web applications using both React and Vue, Java, as well as Next.js and Spring Boot, PostgreSQL, and AWS.
- Contributed tool_choice support and prompt cache management to Spring AI's Anthropic integration, both merged into the framework.
- Shipped the Equitize product from conception to launch, scaling to millions in transaction volume.
- Adopted modern dev tooling (Testcontainers, Retool, Auth0, Java 21, JOOQ, GraphQL) to reduce development friction and improve team velocity.

Jan 2021 – Jan 2022

Senior Software Engineer

Worked on Daily Processing infrastructure handling payments, KYC, and share issuance.

- Architected new ACH processing system handling \$1B+ in annual transaction volume.
- Shipped Stripe debit funding integration, processing 40k+ transactions in year one.
- Automated transfer agent reconciliation, eliminating manual shareholding processing and reconciliation errors.
- Built department-wide test data framework, enabling rapid local development iteration across engineering.

Nov 2019 – Jan 2021

Software Engineer

Responsible for auto-invest scheduling and KYC system development, delivering core infrastructure for new product lines.

- Shipped IRA product from conception to production, establishing new asset class offering.
- Designed and shipped Short Term Notes backend processing system.
- Streamlined KYC and investment approval workflows, reducing approval time and processing errors.

Travelers

Mar 2016 – Nov 2019

Apr 2019 – Nov 2019

Associate Software Developer

Built proprietary software and ML pipeline systems. Developed deployment execution management platform using Java, Spring Boot, and Python.

- Built ML pipeline components working with SQLServer and Oracle data systems.

Apr 2017 – Apr 2019

Senior Software Programmer

Owned development of internal applications and tools using Java and Spring Boot.

- Migrated legacy Perl tooling suite to modern Python and Java/Spring Boot applications, reducing maintenance overhead and improving developer experience.

Mar 2016 – Apr 2017

Software Programmer

Developed proprietary software and internal systems.

- Shipped proprietary software using Perl, Java, Spring Boot.
- Owned release process, executing nightly production deployments as part of deployment train.

Education

2019	M.S. Computer Science Towson University
2015	B.S. Information Systems University of Maryland, College Park

Skills

APPLIED AI	Anthropic Claude API / OpenAI API / AWS Bedrock / Spring AI / Prompt & context design / Tool use and agent loops / Prompt caching / RAG / Evaluation & regression testing / Machine learning
LANGUAGES	Java / TypeScript / Python / SQL
BACKEND & DATA	Spring Boot / PostgreSQL / JOOQ / GraphQL / Testcontainers / Event-driven processing
WEB	React / Next.js / Vue / Tailwind CSS
PLATFORM	AWS / Vercel / Stripe / Auth0 / Okta / Retool
DOMAIN	Payments & ACH / KYC and compliance workflows / Private securities / Regulated systems design